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Ryz is a network that comprises experienced enthusiastic professionals who exchange knowledge and ideas—the very reason why I logged on to it a couple of months back.

The network lets me reach out to new people, track down long-lost friends, share and receive business proposals and make use of my communication skills. There's also a lot of goodwill I have gained—an asset that competition cannot undersell or destroy. Apart from business, people post their views on current happenings. Another important benefit is member "credibility." Profiles posted here are mostly correct: the fictitious ones get filtered overtime.

Logging onto the network has become part of a daily routine. The number of people you meet with depends on the way you interact with members. An active Ryzer makes five to seven contacts per week.

As for offline meetings, we have 'mixers': An open invitation detailing the time and place of the meet is sent to all the members of a particular group. Such get-togethers take place once every month and result in plenty of interaction on both, personal and the business fronts.



NETTING

ONLINE Social networking has come of age. From merely making friends and socialising, they now let you get business done and clinch deals. We spoke to five professionals who have netted gains through such interaction



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I joined Ryze in October 2003. First, a friend told me about this unique way of meeting people from diverse backgrounds and then, its personalised blog-like format caught my interest. I browse through the site three to four times a day and, on an average two to three contacts per week.

'Mixers' (offline meetings) take place frequently in various cities. Then there are one-to-one meetings wherein individuals meet to share their own personal thoughts or interests.

The benefits have been both personal as well as professional. I might come across a person pursuing trekking full-time, with whom I can tag along to pursue my hobby: These are personal benefits.

Being a marketing professional (with frequent cross-country trips), it has helped me forge ties with many potential business partners. Also, if I come across a person who owns a corporate gifts agency, I can touch base with that individual to get a good deal for my company. Above all though, I learn about other cities via their resident Ryzers. Their 'tidbits' serve as a pretty introduction when I criss-cross through that city.